

THE HOPECORE PROJECT

Free

Free GitHub Copilot Free \$0 2,000 completions/month + 50 chat messages. Best free tier for VS Code & JetBrains. ■ Free unlimited via Student Developer Pack autocomplete · ide	Free Windsurf (Codeium) \$0 Unlimited inline completions. Powerful AI-native IDE forked from VS Code. ide · autocomplete
Free Gemini Code Assist \$0 180,000 completions/month — the most generous free quota of any major tool. autocomplete	Free Amazon Q Developer \$0 Formerly CodeWhisperer. Unlimited completions on free tier. Great for AWS devs. autocomplete · agent
Free Continue.dev \$0 Fully open-source IDE extension. Use any local or API model. No usage caps. ide · autocomplete	Free Tabnine Free \$0 Basic completions with a local model — code never leaves your machine. autocomplete
Free Aider \$0 + API cost Open-source terminal coding agent. Works with Claude, GPT, and local models. agent	Free Replit AI (Free) \$0 Browser-based coding with AI built in. Zero setup — ideal for learning. ■ Replit Teams for Education is free for classrooms ide
Free Codex CLI (OpenAI) \$0 (open source) Open-source terminal agent from OpenAI. Bring your own API key. agent	

Daily / Usage Limit

Limit Cursor (Hobby) \$0 free / \$20 Pro AI IDE with limited free Agent + completions monthly. Pro unlocks full usage. ■ 1 year of Pro FREE with school email (.edu, .ac.in) ide · agent	Limit ChatGPT (GPT-4o) \$0 free / \$20 Plus General-purpose AI with strong coding. Free tier has daily message limits. ■ No official discount; use API credits for cheaper access agent
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Limit Claude (Anthropic) \$0 free / \$20 Pro Excellent for complex reasoning and long code reviews. Free has usage limits. ■ No official student discount currently agent	Limit JetBrains AI (Free) \$0 / \$10 Pro 3 AI credits/30 days on free tier, unlimited basic completions. Deep IDE integration. ■ FREE via JetBrains Student Program (all IDEs included) autocomplete · ide
Limit Windsurf Pro (Free Tier) 25 credits/mo free 25 free credits/month — enough to evaluate, not for heavy daily use. ide · agent	Limit v0 by Vercel Monthly credits free AI-powered React/frontend component generator with monthly free credit allocation. agent
Limit Bolt.new 1M tokens/mo free Full-stack AI app builder in the browser. Generous free token allowance. agent · ide	Limit Perplexity (Coding) \$0 / \$20 Pro Great for quick code Q&A; and web-sourced answers. Free tier has daily limits. ■ Free Pro for students via select university programs agent

Paid

Paid Claude Code \$20–\$100/mo Top-ranked agent (80.8% SWE-bench). Terminal-based, handles full codebases. ■ Free API credits for new Anthropic accounts agent	Paid Cursor Pro / Ultra \$20–\$200/mo Best AI IDE overall. Unlimited Auto mode on Pro. Ultra (\$200) for power users. ■ 1 year Pro FREE with verified student email ide · agent · autocomplete
Paid GitHub Copilot Pro+ \$20/mo 300 premium requests/mo, multi-model (Claude Opus, GPT), cloud agent, code review. ■ FREE for verified students via GitHub Education autocomplete · agent	Paid Windsurf Pro / Max \$15–\$60/mo Cascade agent for complex multi-file tasks. Max (\$60) for heavy usage. ide · agent · autocomplete
Paid Tabnine Pro / Enterprise \$9–\$59/mo Privacy-first AI, on-premises/air-gapped options. Best for regulated industries. autocomplete	Paid JetBrains AI Pro \$10–\$30/mo Deep integration with IntelliJ, PyCharm, WebStorm + Junie agent credits shared. ■ FREE via JetBrains Student Program ide · autocomplete · agent
Paid Amazon Q Developer Pro \$19/user/mo Full agent with AWS-aware suggestions, security scanning, code transformation. agent · autocomplete	Paid Replit Core \$20/mo Full cloud IDE with AI, deployments, collaboration, and always-on repls. ■ 50% off via GitHub Student Developer Pack ide · agent

Paid **GitHub Copilot Business**

\$19/user/mo

Team-wide codebase indexing, policy controls,
audit logs, multi-model support.

autocomplete · agent

Tips, Student Offers & Hidden Deals

■ **Student**

GitHub Student Developer Pack — Best student deal in tech

Verified students get GitHub Copilot Pro free (unlimited completions), plus \$200+ in credits from AWS, DigitalOcean, JetBrains, Namecheap, MongoDB, and 100+ more partners. Apply at education.github.com with a .edu email or student ID.

■ **Student**

Cursor Pro — 1 Year Free for Students

Sign up at cursor.com/students with your institutional email (.edu, .ac.in, .ac.uk etc.). Includes full Pro: unlimited completions, Agent mode, and \$20/month in credits. Renewable while enrolled.

■ **Student**

JetBrains Student Program — All IDEs + AI Free

Students and teachers get free access to ALL JetBrains IDEs (IntelliJ, PyCharm, WebStorm, etc.) AND JetBrains AI Assistant. Apply at jetbrains.com/student with an academic email.

■ **Student**

Replit 50% Off via Student Pack

GitHub Student Developer Pack includes 50% off Replit Core (\$20 -> \$10/mo). Great for browser-based coding and sharing projects without local setup.

■ **Student**

Open-source maintainers: GitHub Copilot Pro Free

Maintainers of popular open-source projects on GitHub qualify for free Copilot Pro — same as the student offer. Apply via GitHub Education at education.github.com.

■ **Tip**

Stack free tools to replace a \$20/month subscription

Combine: GitHub Copilot Free (completions in VS Code) + Gemini Code Assist (180K monthly tokens) + Continue.dev (open-source, no cap) for a zero-cost daily workflow.

■ **Tip**

Use Amazon Q Developer if you code for AWS

Free tier has unlimited completions plus deep knowledge of all AWS APIs, IAM policies, and CDK. No other free tool comes close for cloud-native development.

■ **Tip**

Tabnine for privacy-sensitive or confidential code

If you can't send your code to the cloud (client NDAs, healthcare, finance), Tabnine's free tier uses a local model that never leaves your machine.

■ **Tip**

Claude Code free credits on new Anthropic accounts

New Anthropic API accounts receive free credits. Combined with the open-source CLI, this gives you access to the top-ranked coding agent at no upfront cost.

■ **Tip**

JetBrains annual billing saves ~40%

JetBrains IDE and AI Pro subscriptions are ~40% cheaper on annual plans vs monthly. First year is discounted; price rises in Y2-Y3, but the student plan is always free.